



MEONCROSS SCHOOL | HISTORY DEPARTMENT

FROM DEMOCRACY TO DICTATORSHIP: HOW DID HITLER DESTROY THE WEIMAR REPUBLIC?

*Paper 3: Weimar and Nazi Germany, 1918-39 -
Key Topic 2: Hitler's Rise to Power, 1919-33*

Scholar: _____

Class: _____

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

TARGET GRADE: _____

Grade	9-1 GCSE Grading Scale		
Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: KT2.1: The Early Development of the Nazi Party, 1919–1922			
L2: KT2.2: The Munich Putsch and the Lean Years, 1923–1929			
L3: KT2.3: The Growth of Nazi Support, 1929–1932			
L4: KT2.4: How Hitler Became Chancellor, 1932–1933			
Final Unit Grade:			

L1: KT2.1: The Early Development of the Nazi Party, 1919–1922

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise knowledge of the 25-Point Programme and explain how it was designed to appeal to multiple different groups in German society.
- ☐ Analyse the methods Adolf Hitler used to take total control of the party, including his public speaking, party restructuring, and early propaganda.
- ☐ Evaluate the role and impact of the SA (Sturmabteilung), explaining how political violence became a core tactic of the early Nazi Party.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What was the Spartacist Uprising (1919)?

Who led the Spartacist Uprising?

Who were the Freikorps?

What was the Kapp Putsch (1920)?

How did the government defeat the Kapp Putsch?

How much were the reparations set at?

What was the War Guilt Clause?

What was Article 48?

What was the 'stab in the back' myth?

What is a 'republic'?

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

DAP (German Workers' Party) | NSDAP (National Socialist German Workers' Party) | 25-Point Programme | Nationalism | Socialism | SA (Sturmabteilung) | Stosstrupp (Shock Troop) | Völkischer Beobachter

In 1919, Anton Drexler founded the tiny [.]. A year later, Hitler rebranded it as the [.] and helped write the [.]. This manifesto blended extreme [.] with ideas of [.] to appeal to the working class. To spread their message, the party purchased the [.] newspaper. By 1921, Hitler set up the [.] to protect meetings, but later created an elite [.] as his personal bodyguard.

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Why did the Nazi Party appeal to people in the early 1920s?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q2. Complete the following sentences based on the provided narrative: 1) Hitler joined the DAP in 1919 BUT... 2) The DAP changed its name to NSDAP in 1920 BECAUSE... 3) The SA was formed in 1921 SO...

Vocabulary in Context

Q3. Write a short paragraph (approx. 75-100 words) describing the early development of the Nazi Party, ensuring you use at least FIVE of the following keywords: DAP, NSDAP, 25-Point Programme, Nationalism, Socialism, SA, Stosstrupp, Völkischer Beobachter.

Causal Linkage

Q4. Explain the causal link between Hitler's leadership and the rapid growth and radicalisation of the Nazi Party between 1919 and 1922. How did his actions directly contribute to these outcomes?

Counter-Factual History

Q5. Imagine that the **SA (Sturmabteilung) was never formed, or was quickly suppressed by authorities, during the 1919-1922 period. How might the early development of the Nazi Party have differed significantly, and what implications would this have had for its ability to gain influence?**

GCSE Exam Practice

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

Q6. 2. Explain why the Nazi Party grew in support between 1919 and 1922 .

You may use the following in your answer:

- Hitler's oratorical skills
- The 25-Point Programme

You must also use information of your own.

[12 marks • 15 mins]

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Exam Sources & Interpretations

Source A: Point 4 of the 25-Point Programme, published in February 1920.

"None but members of the nation may be citizens of the state. None but those of German blood... may be members of the nation. No Jew, therefore, may be a member of the nation."

Source B (Contemporary Written Source):

From a diary of an early party member, Munich, 1921.

"When Hitler took the platform, the entire beer hall was silent with anticipation. He spoke for nearly two hours, moving from a slow, quiet whisper to a booming, furious rage against the treaty. His intense gaze and violent hand gestures drew everyone in. By the end, men and women were in tears, completely captured by his absolute belief that he was the savior of Germany."

Source C (Contemporary Written Source):

From the official DAP Twenty-Five Point Programme, declared February 1920.

"We demand the immediate destruction of the Treaty of Versailles and the unification of all Germans in a Greater Germany. We demand land and colonies to feed our population. Only those of German blood can be citizens; therefore, no Jew may be a citizen. The state's primary duty is to provide jobs and livelihoods for citizens."

Interpretation 1 (The Structured Ideology View):

The rapid expansion of the early Nazi Party was fundamentally driven by the targeted appeal of its 25-Point Programme. By cleverly combining aggressive nationalism, extreme anti-Semitism, and socialist welfare promises, the manifesto acted as a highly effective catch-all document. It offered simple, clear solutions and immediate scapegoats to multiple disgruntled classes, particularly the demobilized soldiers and lower middle class.

Interpretation 2 (The Charismatic Oratory View):

The Nazi Party's program was largely secondary to the hypnotic, personal magnetism of Adolf Hitler. In a politically chaotic Bavaria, Hitler emerged as a dynamic, modern communicator who rehearsed his speeches theatrically to project strength and conviction. It was his unique oratorical star power, combined with the physical violence of Ernst Röhm's SA, that attracted members and secured his absolute leadership over the movement.

Q7. 1. Give two things you can infer from Source A about the core beliefs of the Nazi Party in 1920.

(i) What I can infer:

Details in the source that tell me this:

(ii) What I can infer:

Details in the source that tell me this:

[4 marks • 5 mins]

Q8. 3a. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the early appeal and rhetoric of the Nazi Party, 1919-1922?

[8 marks • 10 mins]

Q9. 3b. Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about the early appeal and rhetoric of the Nazi Party. What is the main difference between these views?

[4 marks • 5 mins]

Q10. 3c. Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about the early appeal and rhetoric of the Nazi Party. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer.

[4 marks • 5 mins]

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

Q11. 3d. How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the early appeal and rhetoric of the Nazi Party? Explain your answer, using both interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context.

[16 marks • 20 mins]

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L2: KT2.2: The Munich Putsch and the Lean Years, 1923–1929

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise knowledge of the short-term and long-term causes, events, and immediate consequences of the 1923 Munich Putsch.
- ☐ Analyse how Hitler used his time in prison to write Mein Kampf and fundamentally change the strategy and structure of the Nazi Party.
- ☐ Evaluate why the Nazi Party struggled to win electoral support between 1924 and 1928, despite their highly effective internal reorganisation.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Why did France and Belgium invade the Ruhr in 1923?

How did German workers react to the Ruhr invasion?

What caused Hyperinflation in 1923?

Who suffered most from Hyperinflation?

Who benefitted from Hyperinflation?

Who were the Freikorps?

Who led the Spartacist Uprising?

How was the Kapp Putsch defeated?

What was Proportional Representation?

What were the military restrictions of the Treaty of Versailles?

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

**The Bavarian Triumvirate | Treason | Landsberg Prison | Mein Kampf ('My Struggle') |
Führerprinzip (The Leadership Principle) | Gauleiter | SS (Schutzstaffel) | Aryan**

Your Sentence:

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Was the Munich Putsch a total failure for Hitler?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q2. Complete the following sentences based on the lesson narrative:

- 1. Hitler's Munich Putsch failed to seize power in 1923, BUT...**
- 2. Hitler received a lenient sentence for treason BECAUSE...**
- 3. During his time in Landsberg Prison, Hitler wrote *Mein Kampf*, SO...**

Vocabulary in Context

Q3. Using at least FOUR of the following keywords – *Mein Kampf*, Führerprinzip, Gauleiter, SS, Aryan, Landsberg Prison, Treason – explain how Hitler used his time in prison and the subsequent "Lean Years" to reshape the Nazi Party and its ideology.

Causal Linkage

Q4. Explain how the failure of the Munich Putsch and Hitler's subsequent imprisonment, despite being a setback, ultimately strengthened his position and the long-term trajectory of the Nazi Party.

The 'What If' Challenge

Q5. Imagine a counter-factual scenario where the Bavarian Triumvirate (Kahr, Lossow, Seisser) had *not* reneged on their initial agreement with Hitler during the Munich Putsch, and instead had supported his 'national revolution'. What might have been the immediate and long-term consequences for Germany, the Weimar Republic, and the rise of Nazism? Consider both political and social impacts.

GCSE Exam Practice

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

Q6. 2. Explain why the Nazi Party experienced the 'Lean Years' between 1924 and 1928 .

You may use the following in your answer:

- **Stresemann's economic policies**
- **Hitler's reorganization of the party**

You must also use information of your own.

[12 marks • 15 mins]

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Exam Sources & Interpretations

Source A: Adolf Hitler speaking at his trial for treason, February 1924.

"I alone bear the responsibility. But I am not a criminal because of that... There is no such thing as high treason against the traitors of 1918. I consider myself not a traitor, but a German, who wanted the best for his people."

Source B (Contemporary Written Source):

From a letter written by a local Nazi party organizer in Hanover, May 1928.

"Our election results are an absolute disaster; we have won only twelve seats in the Reichstag, and the public completely ignores us. People are happy with Stresemann's American loans and do not want to hear our warnings. But we must not lose heart. Our party is now highly organized, we have divided Germany into Gaue, and we have established our own youth and professional leagues. We are waiting for the economic storm to break."

Source C (Contemporary Written Source):

From notes taken at the Nazi Party conference in Bamberg, February 1926.

"The Leader spoke for over two hours, asserting that there can be no division within our ranks. He declared that the NSDAP must be run strictly according to the Führerprinzip (the Leadership Principle), which demands absolute, unquestioning obedience to him as the supreme leader. The socialist proposals of the northern Gauleiters have been completely rejected, and the 25-Point Programme is declared unalterable."

Interpretation 1 (The Political Failure View):

During the era of economic stabilization, the Nazi Party was an irrelevant, failing extremist group whose message was treated as a joke by the vast majority of voters. With hyperinflation resolved and national pride partially restored under Stresemann, support for political extremism withered away, leaving the NSDAP as a spent force that was largely ignored by the German public.

Interpretation 2 (The Vital Reorganization View):

The period between 1924 and 1928 was a highly successful and vital era of party reorganization. By establishing regional Gaue, creating a centralized bureaucracy, and asserting absolute control under the Führerprinzip, Hitler transformed a chaotic paramilitary group into a highly disciplined, national political machine ready to exploit a future economic crisis.

Q7. 1. Give two things you can infer from Source A about Adolf Hitler's attitude towards the Weimar government during his 1924 trial.

(i) What I can infer:

Details in the source that tell me this:

(ii) What I can infer:

Details in the source that tell me this:

[4 marks • 5 mins]

1

[8 marks • 10 mins]

Q9. 3b. Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about the 'Lean Years' of the Nazi Party between 1924 and 1928. What is the main difference between these views?

[4 marks • 5 mins]

Q10. 3c. Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about the 'Lean Years' of the Nazi Party between 1924 and 1928. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer.

[4 marks • 5 mins]

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

Q11. 3d. How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the 'Lean Years' of the Nazi Party between 1924 and 1928? Explain your answer, using both interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context.

[16 marks • 20 mins]

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General Notes

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L3: KT2.3: The Growth of Nazi Support, 1929–1932

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise knowledge of the economic and social impacts of the 1929 Wall Street Crash on Germany.
- ☐ Analyse the political paralysis of the Weimar Republic, explaining why the collapse of Müller's coalition and Brüning's policies caused voters to flock to extremist parties.
- ☐ Evaluate the reasons for the surge in Nazi support, judging the relative importance of Hitler's personal appeal, Goebbels' propaganda, Big Business funding, and the violence of the SA.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Who became Chancellor in 1923 and helped end hyperinflation?

What new currency did Stresemann introduce in 1923?

What was the Dawes Plan (1924)?

What was the Young Plan (1929)?

What was the Locarno Pact (1925)?

Why did France invade the Ruhr in 1923?

What was passive resistance?

Who suffered most from hyperinflation?

What was the Kapp Putsch?

What was Article 231?

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: ***The Wall Street Crash***

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Why did Nazi support surge after 1929?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q2. Complete the following sentences based on the lesson narrative: 1) The Grand Coalition government under Hermann Müller collapsed BUT... 2) Heinrich Brüning increasingly relied on Article 48 BECAUSE... 3) Nazi support grew dramatically between 1929 and 1932 SO...

Vocabulary in Context

Q3. Write a short paragraph (approximately 100-150 words) explaining the political and economic crisis in Germany between 1929-1932, accurately using at least five of the following keywords: Wall Street Crash, Hermann Müller, Heinrich Brüning, Article 48, KPD, Negative Cohesion, Rotfrontkämpferbund.

Prioritising Causes

Q4. Identify and explain the *two most significant* reasons for the rapid growth of Nazi support between 1929 and 1932, justifying your choices with specific evidence from the lesson narrative.

Counter-Factual History

Q5. "If the Wall Street Crash had not occurred in October 1929, the Nazis would never have come to power." To what extent do you agree with this statement? Justify your answer with reference to the lesson narrative, considering both arguments for and against the statement.

GCSE Exam Practice

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

Q6. 2. Explain why Nazi support grew between 1929–1932 .

You may use the following in your answer:

- **The impact of the Great Depression**
- **Hitler's charismatic appeal and propaganda**

You must also use information of your own.

[12 marks • 15 mins]

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Exam Sources & Interpretations

Source A: A diary entry by a German middle-class teacher, 1931.

"The economic situation is terrifying. Unemployment is rising every week. The Weimar politicians do nothing but argue. Many of my friends are turning to the National Socialists because they promise strong leadership and a way out of this misery."

Source B (Contemporary Written Source): From the diary of Luise Solnitz, a schoolteacher in Hamburg, March 1932.

There stood Hitler in a simple black coat, looking over the crowd of 120,000 people of all classes and ages. A forest of swastika flags unfurled, the joy of this moment showed itself in roaring salute. The crowd looked up to show Hitler with touching faith, as their helper, their savior, their deliverer from unbearable distress. He is the rescuer of the scholar, the farmer, the worker, and the unemployed.

Source C (Contemporary Written Source): From an article describing the conditions of the unemployed in Berlin, 1931.

The municipal lodging houses are filled to capacity with young, unemployed men. They completely fill the streets, standing or lying about in silence. The streets are grey, their faces are grey, and even the hair on their heads and the stubble on the cheeks of the youngest there was grey with dust and their adversity. They have lost all hope, having been completely abandoned by the Weimar government's welfare cuts.

Interpretation 1 (The Economic Depression View):

The Nazi rise to power was fundamentally caused by the catastrophic economic distress of the Great Depression. The sudden withdrawal of US loans caused businesses to collapse and pushed unemployment over 6 million, which completely paralyzed the democratic system and forced desperate voters to turn to extremist parties. Without this economic crisis, the Nazis would have remained on the political margins.

Interpretation 2 (The Hitler's Charisma View):

The primary driver behind the surge in Nazi support was the unique, charismatic appeal of Adolf Hitler. At a time of intense national despair, Hitler brilliantly projected himself as a dynamic, modern, and strong leader who stood above traditional party politics. His powerful public speaking and carefully staged campaigns convinced Germans of all classes that he alone understood their personal suffering and could rescue the nation.

Q7. 1. Give two things you can infer from Source A about the impact of the Great Depression on ordinary Germans.

(i) What I can infer:

Details in the source that tell me this:

(ii) What I can infer:

Details in the source that tell me this:

[4 marks • 5 mins]

Q8. 3a. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the growth of Nazi support, 1929–1932?

[8 marks • 10 mins]

[illegible]

Q9. 3b. Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about the growth of Nazi support, 1929–1932. What is the main difference between these views?

[4 marks • 5 mins]

Q10. 3c. Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about the growth of Nazi support, 1929–1932. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer.

[4 marks • 5 mins]

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

100

[16 marks • 20 mins]

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General Notes

[illegible]

L4: KT2.4: How Hitler Became Chancellor, 1932–1933

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise chronological knowledge of the rapid succession of Weimar Chancellors between 1930 and 1933 (Brüning, von Papen, von Schleicher).
- ☐ Analyse the political scheming ("backstairs intrigue") between President Hindenburg, his inner circle, Franz von Papen, and the conservative elites.
- ☐ Evaluate why Hindenburg finally agreed to appoint Hitler as Chancellor despite his deep personal hatred for him, understanding the fatal miscalculation the elites made.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

When did Germany join the League of Nations?

What was the Kellogg-Briand Pact (1928)?

Why did the 'Golden Age' (1924-29) rely on 'dancing on a volcano'?

How did culture change during the Golden Age?

What did Stresemann introduce to fix hyperinflation?

What was the Dawes Plan?

What was the Young Plan?

What was the Locarno Pact?

Why did the French invade the Ruhr?

Who were the November Criminals?

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

**Paul von Hindenburg | The Camarilla | Franz von Papen | Kurt von Schleicher | Backstairs
Intrigue | Cabinet**

By 1932, the ageing President [.] was heavily influenced by a small group of advisors known as [.]. After the fall of Brüning, the President appointed the conservative [.] as Chancellor, but he lacked support. Following the brief and disastrous Chancellorship of [.], Papen engaged in [.] —secretly plotting to make Hitler Chancellor. The elites severely underestimated Hitler; they believed that by restricting the number of Nazis in the [.], they could easily control him.

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Did Hitler seize power or was it handed to him?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q2. Complete the following sentences based on the lesson:

- 1. Kurt von Schleicher became Chancellor in December 1932, BUT...**
- 2. Franz von Papen wanted to get back into power BECAUSE...**
- 3. President Hindenburg ultimately appointed Hitler as Chancellor SO...**

Vocabulary in Context

Q3. Write a short paragraph (5-7 sentences) explaining how Hitler became Chancellor, making sure to use ALL the following keywords: Paul von Hindenburg, The Camarilla,

Franz von Papen, Kurt von Schleicher, Backstairs Intrigue, Cabinet. You may underline or bold the keywords in your answer.

Prioritising Causes

Q4. Of the factors described in the lesson, which do you think was the *most* important in Hitler becoming Chancellor? Explain your reasoning. Then, identify one *other* important factor and explain its significance.

Counter-Factual History

Q5. Imagine that President Hindenburg had refused to meet with Franz von Papen and Hitler in early January 1933, or had simply dismissed Papen's proposals outright. What do you think would have been the most likely immediate political consequences for Germany? Consider the roles of Schleicher, the Nazi Party, and the broader political climate.

GCSE Exam Practice

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

Q6. 2. Explain why Hitler became Chancellor in January 1933.

You may use the following in your answer:

- The political instability of the Weimar Republic
- The role of conservative elites

You must also use information of your own.

[12 marks • 15 mins]

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Exam Sources & Interpretations

Source A: A comment by Franz von Papen to a conservative friend in January 1933.

"We have hired him! Within two months we will have pushed Hitler so far into a corner that he'll squeak."

Source B (Contemporary Written Source): From a letter written by Franz von Papen to President Hindenburg, January 1933.

The only way to resolve the political deadlock is to appoint Hitler as Chancellor of a coalition cabinet. I have agreed to serve as Vice-Chancellor, and the majority of cabinet ministers will be conservative. Your Excellency need not fear his radicalism; we have pushed Hitler so far into a corner that we will easily be able to control him like a puppet.

Source C (Contemporary Written Source): From a dispatch by an American journalist stationed in Berlin, December 1932.

The political gridlock is absolute. Chancellor von Schleicher has failed, and the streets are ruled by daily, violent battles between communist and Nazi paramilitaries. The public has completely lost faith in democracy. The government rules solely through unpopular emergency decrees, and the weary voice of the President is completely ignored.

Interpretation 1 (The Democratic Collapse View):

Hitler's rise to power was the inevitable result of the collapse of the Weimar democratic system. The Great Depression permanently paralyzed the Reichstag, forcing a reliance on Article 48 presidential emergency decrees that destroyed democratic legitimacy. By 1932, democracy was already dead, and the conservative elites had to hand power to Hitler because his party was the largest in the parliament.

Interpretation 2 (The Political Intrigue View):

Hitler's appointment as Chancellor was not inevitable, but was the direct result of secret political scheming and backstairs intrigue. The Nazi vote was actually declining by late 1932, and the party was running out of money. Hitler was only rescued because Franz von Papen, President Hindenburg, and conservative landowners made the fatal, cynical miscalculation that they could use his mass popularity to serve their own authoritarian goals.

Q7. 1. Give two things you can infer from Source A about how conservative politicians viewed Adolf Hitler in January 1933.

(i) What I can infer:

Details in the source that tell me this:

(ii) What I can infer:

Details in the source that tell me this:

[4 marks • 5 mins]

Q8. 3a. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into how Hitler became Chancellor in 1932–33?

[8 marks • 10 mins]

Q9. 3b. Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about how Hitler became Chancellor in 1932–33. What is the main difference between these views?

[4 marks • 5 mins]

Q10. 3c. Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about how Hitler became Chancellor in 1932–33. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer.

[4 marks • 5 mins]

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

Q11. 3d. How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about how Hitler became Chancellor in 1932–33? Explain your answer, using both interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context.

[16 marks • 20 mins]

[illegible]

[illegible]

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End of Unit Reflection & Pupil Voice

Unit: Paper 3: Weimar & Nazi Germany (1918–39)

Instructions: Now that you have completed your final assessment, take 10 minutes to reflect on your learning across this entire unit. Be honest—this is your chance to use your **Pupil Voice** to help your teacher plan future lessons.

1. What Went Well (WWW)

What topic or skill did you find most engaging or easiest to understand in this unit?

2. Even Better If (EBI)

What did you find most challenging? Are there any concepts you are still confused about?

3. Effort & Target Setting

Circle your effort level for this unit: **1 (Low)** **2** **3** **4** **5 (Excellent)**

What is one specific target you want to set for yourself in the next unit?

Teacher Feedback & Coaching

(To be completed during live marking / feedback lessons)